Adam Dittrich, PhD

Economic history · Monetary history · Cliometrics · History of economic thought

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Research profile

My research examines the monetary and financial history of interwar Czechoslovakia in a comparative European setting. I study central banking, exchange-rate policy, financial stress, international trade and the Great Depression, combining archival and institutional research with historical data reconstruction and econometric analysis. My work also connects the history of economic thought with policy practice, particularly the ideas of Karel Engliš and Jan Loevenstein. Current collaborative research extends to historical national accounts and the reconstruction of interwar Czechoslovak output.

Academic appointment and teaching

September 2026–present | Assistant Professor, Department of Economic History, Faculty of Economics, Prague University of Economics and Business.

Teaching: Economic History (5HD200); Foundations of Microeconomics (5EN102); Defence of an Academic Paper (55F112).

Education

September 2026 | PhD in Economic History, Prague University of Economics and Business.
Dissertation: *Apriorism in Czech Economics and Its Influence on Czechoslovak Economic History*. Defended on 29 September 2026. Supervisor: Ján Pavlík.

2021 | Ing. (master's degree) in Finance, Faculty of Finance and Accounting, Prague University of Economics and Business. Minor: Financial Engineering.

2019 | Bc. (bachelor's degree) in Finance, Prague University of Economics and Business.

Published and forthcoming journal articles

Dittrich, A. **Forthcoming.** "The Crown Against the World: Reconstructing Czechoslovakia's Effective Exchange Rates, 1920–1938." *Statistika: Statistics and Economy Journal*.

Dittrich, A. **Accepted; publication expected in 2027.** "Spor o cukerní daň roku 1928: Karel Engliš a Gustav Heidler" [The 1928 sugar-tax dispute: Karel Engliš and Gustav Heidler]. *Listy cukrovarnické a řepařské*.

Rytina, J., Dittrich, A., and Drábek, J. (2025). "Historický vztah československého cukrovarnického průmyslu k sociální problematice na příkladu penze: Sociálně solidární cíle mezi lety 1918 až 1926 jako výsledek negativní časové preference" [The Czechoslovak sugar industry and pensions: Social solidarity in 1918–1926 as a result of negative time preference]. *Listy cukrovarnické a řepařské*, 141(9–10), 320–322.

Dittrich, A., Rytina, J., and Drábek, J. (2025). "Cukrovarnický průmysl versus deflační politika: Konflikt hospodářských zájmů v meziválečném Československu" [The sugar industry versus deflationary policy: A conflict of economic interests in interwar Czechoslovakia]. *Listy cukrovarnické a řepařské*, 141(7–8), 260–264.

Dittrich, A. (2023). "Karel Engliš as the Governor of the Czechoslovakian National Bank (1934–1939)." *Revista Română de Studii Eurasiatice*, 19(1–2), 105–124.

Conference proceedings

Dittrich, A. (2025). "Efektivní směnné kurzy Československa 1925–1936: rekonstrukce, dekompozice a efekt devalvace" [Czechoslovakia's effective exchange rates, 1925–1936: Reconstruction, decomposition and the effect of devaluation]. In O. Roubal (ed.), *Konference doktorandů na Vysoké škole finanční a správní 2025*. Prague: VŠFS, pp. 26–40. DOI: 10.37355/KD-2025-02.

Dittrich, A. (2024). "Russian Crisis of 1998." In M. Müller and P. Slavíčková (eds.), *KNOWCON 2024: Knowledge on Economics and Management Conference Proceedings*. Olomouc: Palacký University Olomouc, pp. 26–32.

Manuscripts under revision or review

Measuring Financial Stress under the Gold Standard: Evidence from Interwar Czechoslovakia
Cliometrica — Revise and resubmit.

Measuring the Turning Point in Czechoslovak Foreign Trade during the Great Depression
Prague Economic Papers — Revision following peer review.

Who Paid for Credibility? The Technology of Monetary Defense on Europe's Periphery, 1926–1938
European Review of Economic History — Submitted / under review.

Commercial Hysteresis: Persistence and Reorganization in Europe's Bilateral Trade Geography during the Great Depression
European Review of Economic History — Submitted / under review.

The Koruna-Defence Gap: External Credibility, Real-Rate Restriction and the Great Depression in Interwar Czechoslovakia
Czech Journal of Economics and Finance — Submitted / under review.

Recovery before Jobs: Unemployment, Vacancies, and the State in Interwar Czechoslovakia, 1926–38
Economic History Review — Submitted / under review.

Reassessing Nordic Trade Resilience during the Great Depression: A Bilateral Decomposition of European Trade Flows, 1927–1938
Scandinavian Economic History Review — Submitted / under review.

The Missing J in Interwar Europe: A Monthly Cliometric Dataset on Effective Exchange Rates and Trade-Balance Adjustment, 1925–1936
Journal of Applied Economics — Submitted / under review. Special issue on cliometrics.

Prices Recover, Markets Remember: Late Devaluation and the Erosion of Price Competition in Interwar Czechoslovakia, 1929–1938
Investigaciones de Historia Económica — Submitted / under review.

The Price of Credibility: Quota 90 and Fascist Italy's Internal Deflation in Monthly European Perspective, 1925–1928
Il Pensiero Economico Italiano — Submitted / under review. Special issue on Quota 90.

The Price of Credibility: Central-Bank Law, Monetary Defence, and Domestic Contraction in Interwar Czechoslovakia
European Review of History: Revue européenne d'histoire — Submitted / under review.

Current research and historical data

Historical national accounts. Developing the Czechoslovak contribution to a comparative Central and Eastern European GDP-reconstruction project with Matthias Morys and Marcin Wroński. Current work focuses on agricultural output and value added, sectoral coverage, prices, intermediate inputs and comparability across countries.

Monetary and macroeconomic data. Reconstructing monthly Czechoslovak series from National Bank reports for 1926–1938: central-bank balance sheets, reserves, note circulation, monetary aggregates, lending operations, prices, industrial activity, unemployment, vacancies, exchange rates and foreign trade. Comparative work uses European central-bank and macroeconomic sources and bilateral trade data for 1927–1938.

Source documentation and reproducibility. Digitisation and verification of historical statistical publications; source-level metadata; harmonisation of definitions and reporting breaks; reproducible links between transcribed data and derived indices. The Czechoslovak material is organised around individual projects rather than presented as a single finished public database.

Public replication material. Data and code for the Nordic trade project are available through openICPSR, DOI: 10.3886/E251239V1. The replication deposit is separate from the publication status of the journal manuscript.

Selected working papers and projects in development

Gold Flows, Sterilisation, and the Monetary Base in Interwar Czechoslovakia, 1927–1938. Working paper on reserve movements, domestic balance-sheet operations and changes in the monetary regime after devaluation.

From Bills to Money Markets: The Structural Transformation of the Credit Transmission Mechanism of the National Bank of Czechoslovakia, 1926–1936. Project in development on central-bank credit, the commercial-bill channel and liquidity management.

Crisis as a Failure of Distribution: Jan Loevenstein's Theory of Underconsumption, Technological Unemployment, and the Great Depression. Working paper in the history of economic thought.

Selected research projects

Since 2026 | Research team member. *Frontiers in Empirical Economics: Causal Analysis of Historical Policies, Behavioral Preferences, and Sectoral Resilience*.

Since 2025 | Research team member. *Economic Theory and Social Policy in Interwar Czechoslovakia*.

2022–2023 | Project lead. *Engliš's Monetary Theory and Practice at the Head of the Czechoslovak National Bank*. Internal university research project.

Methods, software and professional development

Methods: Historical source criticism; archival, parliamentary and press research; central-bank balance-sheet reconstruction; index construction and decomposition; time-series and panel econometrics; PPML and gravity models; event studies; synthetic control and comparative counterfactual analysis.

Software: R, Stata and Python; additional experience with EViews and MATLAB.

International Monetary Fund training: Monetary Policy Analysis and Forecasting (2025); Macroeconomic Forecasting (2023).

Professional memberships and languages

Memberships: Economic History Society; Economic History Association; Czech Economic Society.

Languages: Czech (native); English (fluent); German (elementary/intermediate).